

AGILE PRODUCT DEVELOPMENT

Sprint Review and Retrospective

Contributions

Scrum Master:

The scrum master helped keep the team focused and on track throughout the project. This was accomplished through things such as daily scrum meetings and backlog refinement. The daily scrum provided the team with time and space to discuss goals and hinderances. The backlog refinement aided in efficiency and organization. These events provided transparency, collaboration, and continuous improvement for the team.

Product Owner:

The product owner conducted multiple meetings throughout the project. Some of these meetings included an initial and follow-up meeting with the client and meeting with users. During the initial meeting the requirements were gathered, and these requirements were updated in the follow-up meeting. The meeting with users was utilized to create user stories which offered insight into user expectations. These meetings allowed the product owner to see the big picture of expectations and requirements for the project. This provided the product owner with the information needed to create a detailed and well-organized backlog.

Tester:

The tester was able to take the user stories and develop initial test cases. These test cases included specific inputs and acceptance criteria that went into further detail about specific design details such as the usability and the interface. When details were unclear the tester used email to clearly communicate what was needed for clear pass or fail criteria. With this information the tester was able to revise the test cases for optimal testing.

Developer:

The development team was able to communicate the need for clear requirements from the product owner and security testing and bug reports from the tester. This allowed the team to reduce the probability of rework and produced a more secure product. When the client made changes to the requirements by asking to change to wellness-based vacation packages, the development team demonstrated adaptability and was able to seamlessly adjust to meet new expectations.

Completing User Stories

The scrum-agile approach gave a framework for the user stories to be completed. This started with the product owner conducting a focus group to gather user stories. The scrum master was able to incorporate the user stories in scrum events to keep a focus on them throughout the project. This helped the development team gain insight into user expectations and allowed them to develop a product to meet or exceed those expectations. The tester was able to take these user stories and create test cases to ensure that the product clearly met user story goals.

Handling Interruptions

Through iterative development, daily scrum, and backlog adaptability, the scrum-agile approach was able to help bring the project to completion when the project changed direction. During the development process the client wanted to change to wellness-based vacation packages. This change was able to be presented in the daily scrum and incorporated into the backlog. Iterative development made implementation of the change more of a smooth transition.

Communication

Scrum meetings have played a great role in providing clear communication channels for the team throughout the project. These meetings provided initial requirements, transparency, and updates. The meeting to update the team on the client's new requirement of wellness-based vacations is a

prime example of how these meetings allow for clear and efficient communication. The team was notified in a timely fashion, was able to discuss implementing the changes, understand new expectations, and ultimately deliver a product that met these new goals.

Organizational Tools

Using organizational tools and scrum-agile principles assisted the team with planning, execution, and optimization of scrum events. An organizational tool that helped was estimation tools like planning poker and affinity grouping. These tools helped in the planning process by providing a better way to estimate time for tasks to be completed from user stories. Some scrum-agile principles that played a role in completing the project were welcoming change, delivering frequent working solutions, and face-to-face conversation. These principles were present during scrum events such as sprint planning, and daily scrum meetings.

Evaluating Agile Process

The agile process has been extremely helpful throughout the project. It offered flexibility, transparency, faster development, customer collaboration, and adaptability. The downfalls of the agile process have been the lack of predictability and resource intensity. Considering both the pros and cons of this approach, it overall has been the best method for this project. The emphasis on customer collaboration is important for a travel agency product and the flexibility and adaptability paid off when requirements changed mid-project.